

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 7  
 ♥ 10 7 6 4 2  
 ♦ A 6 4 3  
 ♣ 7

♠ A J 5

♥ K Q

♦ Q J 8

♣ 10 9 8 5 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ K Q 10 4 2

♥ 9 8 5

♦ 10 9 7

♣ A 4

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K Q J 6 2

|             |              |             |              |
|-------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
| <i>West</i> | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|             | 1 ♣          | 1 ♠         | 3 ♣          |
| Pass        | 3NT          |             |              |
| All Pass    |              |             |              |

3NT by North  
 while you still have the ♣A for an entry.

[showcards W:SK E:S7 S:S5 N:S3]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠K, West played the ♠7 and North the ♠5.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♦10, NOT another ♠.

You can see the ♠6, ♠5, ♠4, ♠3 and ♠2. So the ♠7 is West's lowest ♠, he is doing his best to discourage you from leading the suit again.

North held up with ♠A J x, hoping you would play the suit again and give him two tricks.

If you play the ♦10 West will win the ♦A and return a ♠, allowing you to drive out North's ♠A

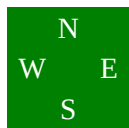
**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 3  
♥ A J 3  
♦ K 5 2  
♣ K Q J 6 2

♠ J 7 5  
♥ 10 7 6 4 2  
♦ A 6 4 3  
♣ 7



♠ A 9 8  
♥ K Q  
♦ Q J 8  
♣ 10 9 8 5 3

♠ K Q 10 4 2  
♥ 9 8 5  
♦ 10 9 7  
♣ A 4

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
| 3♣          | Pass  | 1♣   | 1♠    |
| All Pass    |       | 3NT  |       |
| 3NT by East |       |      |       |

[showcards W:SK E:S7 S:S8 N:S3]

You are South. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠K, North played the ♠7 and East the ♠8.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♠4.

You cannot see the ♠5. The most likely reason is that North has it, and his ♠7 is an encouraging signal. The only reason he would encourage you is if he held either the ♠A or ♠J.

Together, you two continue to play ♠s to drive out East's ♠A. When you get the lead with your ♣A you will cash your ♠ winners and North will still have the ♦A for some icing on the cake.

There IS another possibility if East is a better than average Declarer. North just might hold ♠ 9 7, giving East ♠ A J 8 5. East played the ♠8 as a falsecard to tempt you into playing the suit again. This isn't too likely, but if it happens just congratulate East for the fine play.